

CMSC320

Final Project Checkpoint 1

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GitHub Repository

https://github.com/at-manos/CMSC320_Project

Dataset and Sources

We will use the College Scorecard database from the U.S. Department of Education. The database is composed of information on thousands of universities covering details such as their locations, types, enrollments, tuition, financial aid, graduation rate, student debt level, and post-graduation earnings. The field of study data can also be used for comparison purposes and insights.

Data source: <https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/>

Data documentation: <https://collegescorecard.ed.gov/data/data-documentation/>

Why We Chose This Dataset

This dataset was chosen because choosing a college is an important financial decision and the relationship between the cost and student debts with graduation rates and earnings should be investigated. Also, it will be possible to compare colleges that are public and private and find out what is the connection with the best results.

The dataset is large enough for the project, with both numeric and categorical variables. This is enough to perform data cleaning and organization, visualization, hypothesis testing, and machine learning modeling. Also, it is a good subject for the project because its results may be helpful for students to compare the cost and expected results from different colleges and we can all relate to that.